FaRma — Game Design Concept

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Concept

FaRma is a text-driven Nigerian farming life-sim: you start with a little cash and a big dream, lease or buy land, and build a farm business from one plot of cassava to an agro-empire that supplies Lagos supermarkets and exports.

It keeps the Lagos Life DNA — short choice-driven turns, money pressure, random events, humour and real Nigerian texture — but swaps office politics for soil, rain, workers, "customs" at checkpoints and market women who know your price before you do. It sits beside Naija Banker as a sister title in the same shell: same engine, same save system, a new world.

One-line pitch: "From one plot to the whole market — can you feed Lagos and still make profit?"

Design pillars

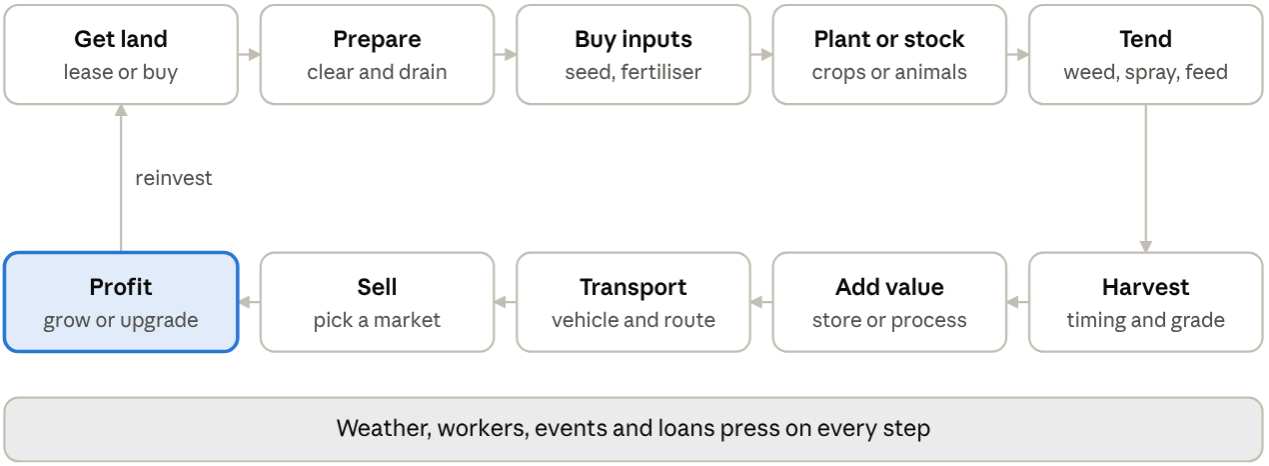
- **Every stage is a choice.** Land, labour, tools, drainage, seed, fertiliser, harvest timing, transport and market each offer 3–5 options with clear trade-offs (cost vs speed vs risk vs quality).
- **Weather and time drive everything.** Rainy and dry seasons decide what you can plant, when roads flood and when prices peak.
- **Value is made after harvest.** Storage, processing and choosing the right market can double what you earn from the same crop.
- **Real Nigeria, played for warmth.** Land grabbers (omo onile), herder clashes, fake fertiliser, bad roads, cooperatives, NIRSAL-style loans and Mile 12 haggling — grounded but never preachy.
- **Short sessions, long arcs.** A turn takes seconds; a season takes minutes; a full career spans 20–30 in-game years.

Audience: Nigerian and diaspora players aged 16–45 who enjoy Lagos Life-style sims; agric students; urban "I want to go into farming" dreamers. Secondary: schools and agric programmes as a light teaching tool.

Core gameplay loop

Each season the player runs the same ten-step loop, with choices at every step, and profit is reinvested to grow the farm.

Every season runs the same loop, and profit funds the next one



core loop · 10 steps per season

Time model: one turn = one day; a month has about 30 turns, but most days auto-advance unless there is a task or event. The year has two main seasons — rainy (April–October, with a short August break in the south) and dry/harmattan (November–March, when only irrigated or fadama land can be farmed). Crops and animals run on their own clocks, so a mature player juggles several loops at once (e.g. broilers every 7 weeks, maize twice a year, oil palm for decades).

Player creation

The player picks a background that sets starting cash, stats and one perk; this gives replay value without a long tutorial.

Background	Starting cash (₦, in-game)	Starting asset	Perk	Drawback
Village heir	250,000	1 plot of family land (no C of O)	Free land, community trust +20	Family wahala events; land dispute risk
Agric graduate (NYSC done)	400,000	None	Yield +10%, soil test discount	Low cash, no network
Lagos tech bro / babe	3,000,000	Smartphone farm-app access	Fast market price info	Workers distrust "city people"; theft risk +15%

Background	Starting cash (₦, in-game)	Starting asset	Perk	Drawback
Retired civil servant	5,000,000	Pension + Toyota pickup	Loan approval +20%	Energy stat caps lower; slower actions
Returnee from abroad ("JJC")	8,000,000	Foreign savings	Can import equipment	Gets overcharged at first; scam events
Market woman's child	600,000	Contacts at Mile 12	Best selling prices from day 1	Knows trade, not farming: yield −10% at start

Player stats (0–100)

- **Farming Skill** — raises yield and cuts crop failure. Grows with every season worked and training.
- **Business Sense** — better haggling, contract terms and price reading.
- **Energy** — spent on hands-on actions; recovered by rest, food and sleep.
- **Health** — drops from sun, overwork, snake bite or malaria events.
- **Reputation** — how buyers, workers, banks and the community see you.
- **Network** — number and quality of contacts (buyers, officials, transporters).

Players also choose a name, gender, home state and a farm name (e.g. "Iya Bisi Farms", "Golden Harvest Agro Ventures").

Land

Land is the first big decision: size, soil, location and how you hold it set your ceiling and your risks for the whole run.

Sizes

Size	Area	Suits	Typical workers
Backyard plot	1 plot (~0.05 ha)	Vegetables, poultry, snails	0–1
Small farm	1–2 hectares	Cassava, maize, pepper, fish ponds	2–4
Medium farm	5–20 hectares	Mixed crops, piggery, poultry house	5–15

Size	Area	Suits	Typical workers
Large farm	50–100 hectares	Rice, maize, soybean at scale; mechanised	15–40
Estate / plantation	200+ hectares	Oil palm, cocoa, cashew, ranching	40+ with managers

Soil and terrain types

Type	Strength	Weakness	Best for
Loamy	High fertility, drains well	Expensive	Almost everything
Sandy	Cheap, easy to till	Holds little water or nutrient	Groundnut, watermelon, cashew
Clay	Holds water	Waterlogs, hard to till	Rice, sugarcane
Swampy / fadama (floodplain)	Dry-season farming possible	Needs drainage; flood risk	Rice, vegetables in dry season
Forest land	Very fertile once cleared	Heavy clearing cost	Cocoa, oil palm, plantain
Savannah	Large, flat, cheap	Low rain in the north; herder routes	Maize, sorghum, soybean, cattle
Rocky / laterite	Very cheap	Low yield	Poultry houses, storage, processing sites

Locations (regions with their own crops, prices, weather and events)

- **Lagos/Ogun axis (Epe, Ikorodu, Ijebu, Abeokuta):** pricey land, closest to the biggest market; poultry, fish, vegetables, cassava.
- **Oyo/Osun (Saki, Iseyin, Ogbomoso):** cheap fertile land, cassava, maize, cashew, cattle.
- **Ondo/Ekiti:** cocoa, oil palm, plantain; forest clearing.
- **Benue/Nasarawa ("Food basket"):** yam, soybean, rice, sesame; herder-clash risk.
- **Kano/Kaduna/Jigawa:** tomato, onion, pepper, millet, sorghum, groundnut; irrigation-heavy, dry heat.
- **Kebbi/Niger (Rice belt):** rice, sugarcane; flooding events.
- **Cross River/Akwa Ibom:** oil palm, cocoa, plantain, fish; high rainfall.
- **Plateau (Jos):** potatoes, carrots, strawberries, cabbage; cool climate, premium prices.

How you get land

Route	Cost	Security	Risk / event
Inherit (Village heir)	Free	Low	Uncles and cousins claim a share
Rent / lease yearly	Low upfront	Medium	Landlord raises rent or takes back land after you improve it
Buy from family ("Omo onile")	Medium	Low	Same land sold to 3 people; demands for "foundation fee"
Buy with survey + C of O	High	High	Slow paperwork, bribes for faster processing
Government farm settlement	Medium	Medium	Waitlist; political changes
Join a cluster / outgrower scheme	Low	Medium	Must sell to the anchor company at set price

Land also has hidden traits revealed by a soil test or after the first season: pH, nutrient level, flood-prone, rodents, termites, nearby herder route, good road access.

Workforce

Workers are the farm's engine and its biggest daily headache: each has a skill, reliability and morale score, and how you treat them shows up in your yield.

Worker types

Role	Pay model	Does	Watch out for
Daily labourer ("casual")	Daily wage	Clearing, weeding, harvesting	Doesn't show up on market days
Permanent farmhand	Monthly salary + feeding	All routine work	Demands raise after 6 months
Contract team ("gang")	Per hectare / per job	Fast clearing, ridging, harvest	Rushed work lowers quality
Tractor operator	Monthly or per job	Runs machinery	Uses tractor for side jobs; fuel "leaks"
Livestock attendant	Monthly	Feeding, cleaning, egg collection	Disease spreads if careless

Role	Pay model	Does	Watch out for
Vet doctor (visiting)	Per visit / retainer	Vaccination, treatment	Expensive; scarce in remote areas
Extension officer / agronomist	Fee	Soil test advice, crop plans	Government one is free but rarely comes
Farm manager	High salary	Runs farm while you're away	Can steal or save you; trust stat
Security guard / vigilante	Monthly	Stops theft and grazing	Sleeps on duty
Driver	Monthly	Runs your vehicles	Accidents, "settlement" bills
Sales agent / market rep	Commission	Sells at market for you	Under-reports sales price
Processing staff	Monthly	Garri, palm oil, feed mill work	Need training

Hiring channels: village head referral (reliable, slow), motor park call (fast, risky), agric school interns (cheap, skilled, short-term), labour agent (costs a fee, gives a full team), family members (free-ish but can't be sacked).

Management choices

- Pay on time vs pay late (morale and theft risk).
- Provide feeding, accommodation, transport, health cover (morale boosts).
- Training sessions (skill up, costs time and money).
- Bonuses at harvest; Christmas and Sallah gifts.
- Supervision level: hands-on (uses your Energy) vs trust the manager.

Worker events: strike over pay, worker injured by cutlass, snake bite, someone pregnant/getting married and needs leave, worker caught stealing yams, worker found a better job, worker recommends a cousin.

Equipment and machinery

Equipment trades cash for speed and scale; every item can be bought new, bought "tokunbo" (used, cheaper, breaks more), rented per day, or hired with operator from a tractor-hire service.

Tier	Items	What it unlocks
Hand tools	Cutlass, hoe, rake, shovel, wheelbarrow, knapsack sprayer, watering can	Small plots; heavy Energy and labour use
Small powered	Power tiller, motorised sprayer, water pump, chainsaw, brush cutter	2–5 ha; cuts labour by about a third
Field machinery	Tractor (Massey, John Deere, Mahindra, tokunbo Ford), plough, harrow, ridger, planter, boom sprayer	10+ ha; mechanised land prep
Harvest	Rice thresher, maize sheller, cassava harvester, combine harvester (rent only early)	Faster harvest, less loss
Irrigation	Drip kit, sprinkler set, solar pump, borehole, irrigation canal	Dry-season farming
Livestock	Battery cages, feeders and drinkers, incubator, fish tanks (tarpaulin/concrete), aerator, milking kit	Poultry, fish, dairy scale-up
Processing	Garri fryer, cassava grater, palm oil press, rice mill and destoner, feed mill, grain dryer	Value addition
Power	Generator ("I better pass my neighbour"), solar system, grid connection	Runs pumps, cold rooms, processing
Storage	Barn, silo, hermetic bags, cold room, crate stacks	Hold produce for better prices
Tech (late game)	Drone sprayer, soil sensors, farm app, weather station	Precision bonuses

Equipment stats: condition (0–100%), fuel use, breakdown chance, resale value. Choices each season: service it (cost now), skip service (risk breakdown mid-harvest), or upgrade. Spare parts may only be in Kano or Lagos, so a breakdown can cost days.

Land preparation

Preparation sets the land's "Readiness" score (0–100), which multiplies everything planted on it; each step has a cheap, a balanced and a premium option.

1. **Clearing** — manual slashing (cheap, slow), contract gang (medium), bulldozer (fast, expensive, can strip topsoil), or bush burning (cheap but illegal in some states; fire-spread event, soil damage).
2. **Stumping and debris** — leave stumps (blocks machines) or remove (cost); option to sell timber or make charcoal for side income.
3. **Soil testing** — skip (guesswork), extension officer kit (cheap, rough), private lab (accurate pH and NPK readings that set the right fertiliser plan).
4. **Soil correction** — lime for acidic soil, organic manure, compost, cover crops (slow but builds long-term fertility).
5. **Tillage** — hoe, power tiller, tractor ploughing and harrowing, or zero-tillage with herbicide (cheap now, soil health cost later).
6. **Bed shape** — ridges (cassava, yam), heaps (yam), flat beds (maize, soybean), raised beds (vegetables), basins/paddies (rice).
7. **Fencing and protection** — none, bamboo/stick fence, barbed wire, block wall, solar electric fence; protects against goats, cattle and thieves.

Drainage options (essential on clay and fadama land; flood events check this)

Option	Cost	Effect
None	—	Waterlogging risk in heavy rain; root rot
Hand-dug open ditches	Low	Basic protection; must be cleared yearly
Contour ridges / bunds	Medium	Slows run-off on slopes, stops erosion
Lined channels	High	Durable, low maintenance
Subsurface tile drainage	Very high	Best control; unlocks year-round use

Water and irrigation options

Option	Cost	Effect
Rain-fed only	Free	One main season; drought risk
Stream/river + pump	Low–medium	Dry season possible; river may dry up
Hand-dug well	Low	Small plots only
Borehole	High	Reliable water; needs power
Drip irrigation	High	Saves water; vegetable yield boost
Sprinklers	Medium	Good for large flat fields

Option	Cost	Effect
Government irrigation scheme	Fee	Cheap water, but queue and politics

Inputs

Inputs come in quality tiers and from sellers with different trust levels, so the cheapest bag may be the most expensive mistake.

Seeds and planting material

- **Saved seed** from last harvest: free, yield drops each reuse, disease carries over.
- **Open market seed**: cheap, unknown germination rate (30–90%).
- **Certified/improved seed** (agro-dealer or research institute such as IITA-style stock): high germination, pest-resistant varieties, early maturing.
- **Hybrid seed**: highest yield, must buy new every season.
- **Seedlings and nursery stock** for tomato, pepper, oil palm, cocoa, cashew, plantain suckers, cassava stems, yam setts.

Fertilisers

Type	Use	Note
NPK 15-15-15	All-round base	Most common; price swings with the dollar
NPK 20-10-10	Leafy growth, maize	Good top-up
Urea	Nitrogen boost	Burns plants if overused
SSP / phosphates	Root and fruit	Yam, groundnut
Poultry droppings / cow dung	Organic	Cheap if you keep livestock; smell event
Compost	Organic, slow	Builds soil over seasons
Foliar fertiliser	Quick fix	Spray-on, expensive
Government subsidised bag	Very cheap	Limited, "finished" unless you know someone

Timing and dose are choices too: right time and dose (+yield), late application (smaller boost), overdose (crop burn, wasted money, run-off fine).

Crop protection

- Herbicides (pre-emergence, post-emergence), insecticides (armyworm, stem borers, locusts), fungicides (blight, rot), rodenticides, bird scaring (nets, scarecrow, boys with catapults).
- Organic options: neem extract, pepper spray, crop rotation, intercropping — cheaper, slower, sells at organic premium.
- Integrated pest management unlock (late game): fewer chemicals, better reputation, export eligibility.

Fake inputs mechanic: each seller has a hidden "genuine" rating. Fake fertiliser or adulterated herbicide gives a weak result, discovered mid-season. Players learn which dealers to trust; buying from registered dealers costs more but is safe. A "Report to regulator" option can earn reputation or backfire.

Crops

Crops are grouped by how fast they pay back, so players balance quick cash crops against slow, high-value tree crops. Cycle lengths are game-tuned approximations.

Group	Crop	Cycle (months)	Best soil/region	Game role
Quick cash	Ugwu (fluted pumpkin), spinach (efo), okra	1–2	Loamy, near cities	Steady small income
Quick cash	Tomato, pepper (tatashe, rodo), cucumber	2–4	North dry season, Plateau	Huge price swings, spoils fast
Quick cash	Watermelon	3	Sandy, north	Big profit, heavy, transport-sensitive
Staples	Maize	3–4	Savannah, south-west	Two seasons/year; poultry feed demand
Staples	Rice	4–5	Fadama, clay, Kebbi/Niger	Needs paddy and mill to profit
Staples	Cassava	9–18	Most soils	Hardy, flexible harvest; garri/fufu processing

Group	Crop	Cycle (months)	Best soil/region	Game role
Staples	Yam	8–10	Benue, Nasarawa	Premium tuber; storage barns
Staples	Beans (cowpea), sorghum, millet	3–4	North	Low input, drought-tolerant
Industrial	Soybean, sesame, groundnut	3–5	Benue, Kano, Jigawa	Sell to processors and exporters
Industrial	Sugarcane, ginger, cotton	9–12	Kaduna, Kebbi	Contract farming with factories
Specialty	Irish potato, carrot, strawberry, cabbage	3–4	Plateau	Premium supermarket prices
Specialty	Plantain, banana	9–12	South-south, Ondo	Steady demand
Tree crops	Oil palm	3–4 years to bear	Forest, south	Long-term income for 20+ years
Tree crops	Cocoa, cashew	3–5 years	Ondo, Oyo, Kogi	Export crops, high value
Tree crops	Orange, mango, pineapple	1.5–3 years	Benue, Edo, Ogun	Juice factory contracts

Planting strategies (choices): monocrop (simple, higher risk), intercrop (e.g. cassava + maize; spreads risk), crop rotation (soil health bonus), staggered planting (steady weekly harvests instead of one glut), greenhouse (late-game, year-round tomatoes and peppers).

In-season tasks: weeding rounds (1st, 2nd, 3rd), fertiliser top-up, spraying, staking (yam), thinning, scouting for pests, bird scaring at grain stage. Each task offers "do it yourself", "assign workers" or "skip" with visible consequences.

Livestock, poultry and fish

Animals give faster, steadier cash than most crops but need daily feeding, housing and disease control; they also create manure that cuts crop fertiliser costs.

Enterprise	Options	Cycle	Key decisions	Big risk
Broilers	Day-old chicks, 100 to 10,000 birds	6–8 weeks	Deep litter vs cages; Christmas/Sallah timing	Disease wipe-out, feed price spikes
Layers	Point-of-lay or day-old	18 months laying	Egg crates, cage system	Egg glut in rainy season
Local chicken, turkey, guinea fowl	Free-range	4–8 months	Festive season sales	Hawks, theft
Catfish	Juveniles or fingerlings	4–6 months	Tarpaulin, concrete or earthen ponds; feed brand	Water quality, power outage killing aerators
Tilapia	Fingerlings	5–6 months	Earthen ponds	Slower growth
Pigs	Large White, Landrace crosses	6–8 months to market	Piggery design	African swine fever event
Goats and sheep	Red Sokoto, WAD goats, Yankasa ram	6–12 months	Fattening for Sallah	Theft, straying
Cattle	White Fulani, Sokoto Gudali; fattening or dairy	6 months fattening / ongoing dairy	Ranch vs open grazing; hire herders	Rustling, grazing conflicts
Rabbits and snails	Backyard	3–6 months	Cheap starter enterprises	Low demand in some areas
Bees	Apiary boxes	Harvest 2×/year	Honey and wax	Stings, fire
Grasscutter (cane rat)	Domesticated	6 months	Premium bushmeat	Niche market

Livestock management choices: feed type (commercial brand, self-milled, local mix), vaccination schedule (follow it, delay it, skip it), housing quality, stocking density, biosecurity (footbath, visitor rules), vet retainer, insurance.

Integration bonuses: chicken droppings fertilise crops; maize and soybean feed the poultry via your own feed mill; fish pond water irrigates vegetables; crop residue feeds goats. Integrated farms earn a "Closed Loop" bonus that cuts costs.

Harvest, storage and processing

The harvest decision is about timing and method, and the real profit decision comes after: sell raw now, store and wait, or process into something worth more.

Harvest choices

- **Timing:** early (lower yield, catch high price before the glut), on time (best yield), late (overripe, pest losses, but cassava can wait in the ground).
- **Method:** manual with casuals, contract harvest gang, machine (thresher, combine) — trades cost against speed and post-harvest loss (15–40% loss with poor methods).
- **Sorting and grading:** Grade A (supermarket/export), Grade B (open market), rejects (feed, processing, or give to workers for morale).
- **Off-taker at farm gate:** buyers who come to the farm with cash, paying less but saving transport.

Storage options

Option	Holds	Quality loss per month	Note
Open floor / under the tree	Anything, briefly	High	Rats, rain, theft
Traditional yam barn	Yam	Low–medium	Cheap to build
Hermetic (PICS) bags	Grains, beans	Very low	Stops weevils without chemicals
Warehouse / silo	Grains at scale	Low	Rent or build; enables warehouse receipts
Cold room / solar cold storage hub	Tomato, pepper, fish, meat	Very low	Needs power; game changer for perishables
Freezer	Fish, chicken	Low	NEPA light outage risk

Holding produce is a bet: prices for grains and yam usually rise months after harvest, but storage costs, pest losses and cash-flow needs push against waiting.

Processing (value addition) unlocks

Raw	Processed into	Equipment	Value boost (game-tuned)
Cassava	Garri, fufu, lafun, starch, ethanol (late game)	Grater, press, fryer	×2–3
Oil palm fruit	Red palm oil, palm kernel oil	Oil press, kernel cracker	×2
Paddy rice	Parboiled, destoned polished rice in branded bags	Parboiler, mill, destoner	×2
Maize + soybean	Poultry and fish feed	Feed mill, pelletiser	×1.5 plus own-use savings
Tomato	Paste, dried tomato	Dryer, processing line	Turns waste into income
Fish	Smoked/dried catfish	Smoking kiln	×1.5, longer shelf life
Groundnut	Kuli-kuli, groundnut oil	Press	×1.8
Cocoa, cashew	Dried, graded beans and nuts	Drying yard, grader	Export grade premium
Milk	Wara (local cheese), yoghurt, fura	Dairy kit	×2

Branding unlock: give your processed product a name and logo; brand reputation raises supermarket and online sales over time.

Logistics

Getting produce from farm to market is its own mini-game: each trip picks a vehicle, a route and a departure time, then resolves road events that cost time, money or produce.

Vehicle options (own, hire, or share a load)

Vehicle	Capacity	Best for	Trade-off
Head-load / wheelbarrow	50–100 kg	Farm to roadside	Free, uses Energy
Okada (motorbike)	~150 kg	Short village runs	Cheap, accident risk
Keke (tricycle)	~400 kg	Local market	Cheap, slow on bad roads
Danfo bus (hired, seats out)	~1 tonne	Lagos/Ibadan markets	Easy to find; driver haggles
Pickup / Hilux	1–1.5 tonnes	Mixed loads	Good on rough roads
Mini truck (Mitsubishi Canter, "J5")	3–5 tonnes	Regional trips	Common choice for traders
Trailer / 10-tyre truck ("Tirela")	20–30 tonnes	North-to-south runs (tomato, onion, cattle)	Cheapest per tonne, slow, big losses if delayed
Refrigerated truck	5–10 tonnes	Fish, meat, tomato	Expensive; spoilage near zero
Livestock truck	20–40 cattle or 100+ goats	Animal markets	Animals can die or get stressed
Rail freight (late game)	Large	Kano–Lagos style corridor	Slow, cheap, limited schedule
Air cargo (export)	Small, premium	Export vegetables, fresh produce	Very expensive, needs certification

Trip choices: leave at dawn (cooler, less traffic) vs midday; main highway (faster, more checkpoints) vs bush road (fewer checkpoints, breakdown risk in rainy season); travel alone vs convoy; hire escort for high-value loads.

Road events: potholes and breakdowns, flooded bridges, "union" levies at motor parks, police/customs checkpoints asking for "something for the boys" (pay, argue, or show papers — each has odds), road traffic at Kara bridge, armed robbery on lonely stretches, truck overturn, driver absconds with load, fuel scarcity spikes.

Spoilage model: perishables lose a percentage per hour on the road, reduced by crates (vs sacks), cold trucks and night travel. Tomato in sacks on a 24-hour trailer trip can lose a quarter of its value; plastic crates cut that sharply.

Logistics business (side income): once you own trucks, rent them to other farmers between your own trips.

Markets

Where you sell matters as much as what you grow: each market has its own price level, payment terms, volume limit and personality.

Market	Example (in-game)	Price	Payment	Volume	Character
Farm gate	Buyer comes to you	Low	Cash now	Any	No transport, no stress
Village market	Weekly 5-day market day	Low–medium	Cash	Small	Friendly; prices set by elders
Big city wholesale	Mile 12 (Lagos), Bodija (Ibadan), Oyingbo	Medium–high	Cash, haggle	Large	Middlemen ("Iya Oloja", market unions) control access
Northern hub market	Dawanau grains, Kara cattle, Kano tomato markets	Low buy / bulk	Cash	Very large	Where you buy cheaply to resell or sell grains in bulk
Retail stall	Your own stall or shop	High	Cash	Small	Needs a sales agent; slow
Supermarkets	Shoprite-style chains, local supermarkets	High	30–90 days credit	Medium	Strict grading, packaging, invoices
Hotels, restaurants, caterers, buka	Fast food chains, owambe caterers	High	Weekly/monthly	Steady	Reliable quality wins long contracts
Processors / factories	Flour mills, breweries, feed mills, juice makers	Fixed contract	30 days	Very large	Bulk, steady, lower margin
Government programmes	School feeding, strategic grain reserve	Medium	Slow, may delay	Large	Political contacts help
Commodity exchange	AFEX/NCX-style exchange	Market rate	Fast via warehouse receipt	Large	Needs grading and certified warehouse
Online / social media	WhatsApp, Instagram, delivery app	High	Prepaid	Small	Brand-driven; customer service events

Market	Example (in-game)	Price	Payment	Volume	Character
Export	Sesame, cashew, cocoa, ginger, hibiscus, yam to diaspora	Highest (FX)	Letter of credit	Large	Certification, lab tests, rejected container risk

Price engine: each crop has a base price × season factor (glut at harvest, scarcity before) × regional factor × event factor (fuel price rise, FX change, festive demand at Christmas, Ramadan, Easter) × quality grade. A "Market Prices" screen shows last week's prices per market, with an upgrade (paid price info subscription or a friend in the market) that shows today's prices.

Haggling mini-game: buyer offers a price; you counter. Business Sense, Reputation and the produce's freshness move the odds. Push too hard and the buyer walks; repeat buyers become "customers" who pay more and buy steadily.

Contracts: forward contracts (fixed price before planting), outgrower deals (company supplies inputs, you sell to them), supply contracts with penalties for missed delivery. Side-selling to another buyer for a higher price is possible but hits reputation if discovered.

Money and finance

Cash flow is the main tension: you spend for months before harvest pays, so financing choices decide whether you scale or sink. This is also the natural crossover with Naija Banker.

Source	Speed	Cost	Catch
Family and friends	Fast	Free-ish	Guilt events; they want produce
Esusu / ajo / thrift group	Medium	None	Must wait your turn; members may default
Cooperative society	Medium	Low interest	Must attend meetings; shared equipment and bulk input buying
Microfinance bank	Fast	High interest	Weekly repayments
Commercial bank agric loan	Slow	Medium	Collateral (C of O), business plan, guarantor

Source	Speed	Cost	Catch
Government intervention fund (anchor-borrower style)	Slow	Low/single-digit	Must repay in produce; politics; delays
Input credit from agro-dealer	Fast	Markup	Tied to that dealer
Off-taker pre-finance	Medium	Low	Must sell to them at agreed price
Investors / crowdfunding ("farm sponsorship" platforms)	Medium	Share of profit	If harvest fails, reputation crash
Loan shark	Instant	Very high	Thugs at your gate if late

Insurance: crop insurance (flood, drought), livestock insurance, vehicle insurance. Premiums cut cash now; claims are slow and sometimes disputed.

Grants and competitions: youth-in-agric grants, NGO programmes, agric pitch competitions (a mini-game where your farm stats are scored).

Books and taxes: simple ledger screen (income, costs, profit per crop), optional accountant hire, tax and levies (local government levies, market tolls, state agric permits).

Risks and random events

Events are what make each run a story; every event gives 2–4 responses with different costs and odds, and good preparation (drainage, fencing, insurance, vaccination) shrinks the damage.

Category	Example events	Preparation that helps
Weather	Late rains, drought, flash flood, windstorm flattens maize, harmattan dryness	Irrigation, drainage, insurance, early-maturing seed
Pests and disease	Fall armyworm, locusts, quelea birds, cassava mosaic, Newcastle disease, bird flu, swine fever	Scouting, spraying, vaccination, biosecurity
Security	Herders' cattle eat your crops, theft at night, kidnapping scare on farm road, community youth demand "settlement"	Fencing, guards, community relations, ranch-friendly buffer zones

Category	Example events	Preparation that helps
Land	Omo onile claim, government acquisition for road, boundary dispute with neighbour	C of O, survey, lawyer, village head goodwill
Economy	Fuel price hike, naira devaluation (fertiliser price jumps), export ban, import ban (local rice boom)	Contracts, stockpiling inputs, diversification
People	Worker strike, manager steals, chief demands share of harvest, wedding/burial levy, a politician wants your farm for a campaign photo	Morale, pay on time, Network stat
Market	Glut crashes tomato price, supermarket delays payment, buyer disappears with goods on credit	Storage, processing, cash-only rules, reputation checks
Lucky breaks	Bumper harvest, NGO picks you for a grant, viral social media video, foreign buyer visit, festive season boom	Reputation, branding, quality

Event design rules: no event can end a run alone in the first two seasons; warnings come one turn ahead where realistic (weather forecast, rumours); heavy topics (kidnapping, clashes) stay as risks and tension, never graphic.

Progression and life layer

Players climb seven farmer ranks, each unlocking bigger land, machines, markets and contracts; a light Lagos Life-style personal life runs alongside.

Rank	Title	Unlocks
1	Backyard Farmer	Hand tools, village market, poultry starter
2	Smallholder	1–2 ha, cooperatives, microfinance
3	Commercial Farmer	Tractor hire, city wholesale markets, hotels
4	Agropreneur	Processing, branding, supermarkets, bank loans
5	Agro-Industrialist	Large estates, feed mill, fleet of trucks, factory contracts

Rank	Title	Unlocks
6	Agric Mogul	Export, commodity exchange, multiple states
7	"Baba/Mama Agric" (national icon)	Own agro-company, mentor NPCs, political offers, awards

Achievements: "First Harvest", "Survived the Flood", "Mile 12 Legend" (best haggle), "No Kobo Wasted" (zero post-harvest loss season), "Export Ready", "Closed Loop Farm".

Life layer (kept light): house upgrades (rented room → bungalow → duplex), car, marriage and children, relationships with family who ask for money, church/mosque, owambe parties (spend for Network), health and rest, a friend-group chat with NPC farmers sharing tips and gossip. Ending scores combine net worth, farm size, reputation, community impact (jobs created, school built) and family happiness.

Endings/goals: sandbox by default; optional scenarios like "Feed Lagos" (supply 10,000 tonnes), "Rice Revolution" (beat imported rice on price), "From Ajo to Export" (start with ₦50,000), "Rebuild after Flood".

Screens and UI

The UI stays text-and-card driven like Lagos Life — tap a card, pick an option, see the result as a short story line — so it can be built quickly as a web app and wrapped for mobile.

Main screens

1. **Home / Dashboard** — date and season, weather forecast (3 days), cash, Energy, Health, Reputation, alerts ("Armyworm spotted in Plot 2!").
2. **My Land** — plot cards showing crop, growth stage bar, Readiness, water and pest status; tap a plot for actions.
3. **Shop** — tabs for Seeds, Fertiliser, Chemicals, Tools, Machinery, Livestock, Feed; seller cards show trust rating and price.
4. **Workers** — staff list with morale and skill; Hire, Pay, Train, Sack.
5. **Livestock** — pens/ponds with headcount, weight/age, health, feed stock.
6. **Store** — inventory by quality grade and freshness.
7. **Process** — processing queue and machines.
8. **Transport** — plan a trip: vehicle, route, time; trip result log.
9. **Market** — price board by market; Sell, Haggle, Contracts.
10. **Bank** — loans, ajo, cooperative, insurance, ledger.
11. **Life** — house, family, social, health.

12. **News** — "FaRma Times": fuel prices, FX, weather warnings, policy changes, gossip.

Look and feel: earthy palette (deep green, harmattan orange, soil brown), Nigerian Pidgin and Yoruba/Hausa/Igbo flavour lines ("Oga, rain don start o!"), simple illustrated icons for each crop and animal, satisfying harvest animation, sound of a market crowd on the Market screen.

Turn controls: "Next Day", "Skip to next task", and "Sleep till harvest" (auto-plays with your standing orders and reports events).

Character art and cast

The MVP ships with a cartoon portrait for every person the player meets, so every event card, hire screen and haggle shows a face. That is 36 characters, each with 3 expressions: about 108 images.

Art direction

- **Style:** warm, flat-colour cartoon with bold outlines and slightly big heads; friendly, never mocking. Think children's-book Nigeria, not caricature.
- **Real Nigerian look:** a range of skin tones and features, plus regional dress. Ankara and aso-oke in the south-west, kaftan and babban riga in the north, wrapper and blouse, headties, caps (fila, zana), and work clothes like overalls and wellington boots.
- **Format:** square bust portraits, 512×512 px, transparent background, exported as WebP with a PNG fallback. A circular crop is used in lists; the full bust is shown on event cards.
- **Expressions:** neutral, happy and worried/angry for every character. The game swaps expression by mood: a worker's morale, a buyer's reaction to your counter-offer, a landlord's mood.
- **Consistency:** one character sheet per person (front view, colours, outfit). Every expression is drawn from that sheet so the same face appears across screens.

MVP cast

Group	Characters	Count
Player avatars	6 backgrounds × male and female (Village heir, Agric graduate, Lagos tech bro/babe, Retired civil servant, Returnee, Market woman's child)	12
Workers	Daily labourer, permanent farmhand, tractor operator, livestock attendant, vet, farm manager, security guard, driver	8

Group	Characters	Count
Buyers and market	Farm-gate buyer, market woman (Iya Oloja), middleman, hotel/caterer buyer	4
Suppliers and money	Genuine agro-dealer, shady dealer (fake inputs), ajo/thrift leader, microfinance officer	4
Community and road	Village head (Baale), landlord, omo onile land claimant, herder, checkpoint officer, motor-park union agent (agbero), NPC farmer friend, extension officer	8
Total		**36**

Characters added after the MVP: supermarket buyer, factory buyer, exporter, bank loan officer, loan shark, family members, and politicians.

How we make them: the options are (a) commission a Nigerian illustrator to make the character sheets (most consistent; budget and timeline needed), (b) generate them with an AI image tool using a locked style prompt plus manual clean-up, or (c) build them from a modular avatar kit (shared bodies, swappable faces and outfits). This is cheapest and also lets the player customise their own avatar. A practical mix: kit-based player avatars, and illustrated or generated NPCs.

In the code: each character is one entry in `data/characters.json` (id, name, role, region, outfit notes, image paths per expression). Images live in `images/characters/<id>_<expression>.webp`, so adding a character is a data change only.

Economy balancing

A careful first maize season on 1 hectare should roughly double the money spent, while a sloppy one should only break even — that gap is what teaches the player. All figures below are illustrative in-game Naira for tuning, not real market prices; we should calibrate them against current prices before launch.

Worked season: 1 ha maize, rented land, good choices

Item	Cost (₦)
Land lease (1 year)	50,000
Clearing + tractor ploughing and harrowing	120,000
Improved seed (25 kg)	40,000

Item	Cost (₦)
Fertiliser (NPK + urea, 6 bags)	240,000
Herbicide and insecticide	60,000
Labour: planting, 2 weedings, harvest	150,000
Shelling and bagging	40,000
Transport to city market	60,000
Total cost	**760,000**

Three ways to sell the same 3 tonnes

Choice	Price per tonne (₦)	Revenue (₦)	Profit (₦)
Farm gate at harvest (skip transport)	380,000	1,140,000	440,000
City market at harvest	450,000	1,350,000	590,000
Store 4 months in hermetic bags (+ ₦60,000), then sell	600,000	1,800,000	980,000
Mill into poultry feed for own birds	Saves feed costs	—	Highest long-run value

If the player skips the soil test, buys fake fertiliser and harvests late, yield falls to about 1.5 tonnes and the season ends near break-even.

Tuning levers: base yield per crop, price season curve, event frequency per difficulty (Easy/Normal/"Naija Hard"), loan interest, spoilage rates. Keep all of these in one config file so balancing is a data edit, not a code change.

Monetisation

Free to play with fair, optional spending; nothing sold should let a player skip the farming decisions that make the game worth playing.

- **Rewarded ads:** watch an ad to get a weather forecast extension, a free soil test, or an Energy refill.
- **Premium pass (one-off, around ₦2,000–5,000 or local equivalent):** removes ads, unlocks scenarios and a second save slot.
- **Cosmetics:** farm house styles, tractor colours, farm signboards, outfits.

- **Expansion packs:** "Northern Belt" (irrigation, onions, cattle), "Export Edition", "Agro-Processing Tycoon".
- **Sponsored items (later):** real agro brands, seed companies or banks as in-game sellers with clearly labelled sponsorship.
- **Education licence:** classroom version for agric schools and youth programmes, with teacher dashboard.

Payment via Paystack/Flutterwave for Nigeria plus Google Play and App Store billing.

Build plan

FaRma can reuse the BanKa set-up almost as-is — a static `index.html`, a `js/` folder, an `images/` folder and Netlify hosting with `netlify.toml` and `_headers` — so the first playable version is a content-and-logic job, not new infrastructure.

Proposed folder layout

```
FaRma/
  index.html
  netlify.toml, _headers, .nojekyll
  images/        crops, animals, vehicles, markets, characters/ (cartoon
portraits)
  js/
    engine.js    game clock, turn loop, save/load (localStorage)
    state.js     player, farm, inventory, finances
    land.js      plots, soil, readiness, drainage, irrigation
    crops.js     growth model, tasks, yield calculation
    livestock.js herds, feeding, health, cycles
    workers.js   hiring, morale, wages
    market.js    price engine, haggling, contracts
    logistics.js trips, road events, spoilage
    finance.js   loans, ajo, insurance, ledger
    events.js    random event engine
    ui.js        screens and cards
  data/          crops.json, animals.json, markets.json, vehicles.json,
events.json, config.json
```

Core yield formula (starting point)

$$\text{Yield} = \text{BaseYield} \times \text{Soil} \times \text{Readiness} \times \text{Seed} \times \text{Fertiliser} \times \text{Water} \times \text{Care} \times (1 - \text{PestLoss}) \times \text{Skill}$$

Each factor sits between about 0.3 and 1.3, so one bad choice hurts but does not wipe out the season, while several bad choices compound.

MVP (first playable, about 6–8 weeks part-time)

- One region (Ogun/Oyo), three land sizes, four soil types.
- Five crops (maize, cassava, tomato, pepper, yam) and two livestock (broilers, catfish).
- Hand tools, power tiller, tractor hire.
- Three markets (farm gate, village market, Mile 12) and three vehicles (keke, mini truck, trailer).
- 30 random events, loans from ajo and microfinance, local save.
  - Cartoon portraits for all 36 MVP characters (player avatars, workers, buyers, suppliers, community), each with 3 expressions; see Character art and cast.

Roadmap after MVP

1. **v1.1 Processing and storage:** garri, palm oil, rice milling, cold room, branding.
2. **v1.2 Northern Belt:** Kano/Kaduna/Benue regions, irrigation, onion and tomato trailer runs, cattle.
3. **v1.3 Big business:** supermarkets, factory contracts, commodity exchange, bank loans with collateral.
4. **v2.0 Export and multiplayer:** export certification, leaderboards, cooperative play with friends, shared market prices.
5. **Cross-over with Naija Banker:** a FaRma player can apply for an agric loan from a Naija Banker player's bank, and a banker's RM target can include signing up farmers.

Open questions for you: keep it web-first like BanKa or go straight to an app store build? Pidgin-heavy or mostly English? Should FaRma and Naija Banker share one launcher with "Lagos Life"-style chapters?